[YOUR CONSULTANCY]

[Project title: the outcome the client wants]

Consulting proposal (SAMPLE CONTENT: replace everything in [brackets] and the sample scope)

PREPARED FOR	[Client contact], [Client role], [Client Company]
PREPARED BY	[Your Name], [Your role]
DATE	[Date]
VALID UNTIL	[Validity date, e.g. 30 days from issue]
REFERENCE	[REF-0001] / v1.0

Commercial in confidence. This document contains proposal terms intended solely for the named recipient.

1. Executive summary

[Client Company] takes an average of 11 days to turn an accepted quote into cash. Operations staff re-key shipment charges between the transport management system (TMS) and the accounting package, which slows invoicing, creates disputes and leaves finance without a trustworthy view of margin.

[Your Consultancy] proposes a 16-week programme to diagnose the current process, design a target state, build the TMS-to-accounting integration, pilot it at one depot and, in the recommended option, roll it out to two further depots. The goal is to bring quote-to-cash below 5 days before the 2027 peak season.

At a glance

- Outcome: quote-to-cash under 5 days, measured on pilot-depot data (client target).
- One source of truth for shipment charges, with an audit trail for every change.
- Three options priced from GBP 38,000 to GBP 126,000; we recommend Better.

2. Understanding of your needs

From our discovery call on 18 November we understand the following. These points are the client's account of the situation and will be tested in the diagnosis phase.

Need	What we heard
Speed	Quotes accepted today are invoiced on average 6 days later; cash arrives after a further 5.
Accuracy	Charges are re-keyed by hand, so rate and surcharge errors surface as customer disputes.
Control	Finance cannot reconcile shipment margin without exporting and merging spreadsheets.
Timing	Changes must be live at the pilot depot before the 2027 peak season begins.

3. Approach and phases

We work in four phases. Each phase ends with a milestone review at which the client accepts the deliverables before the next phase starts.

3.1 Timeline

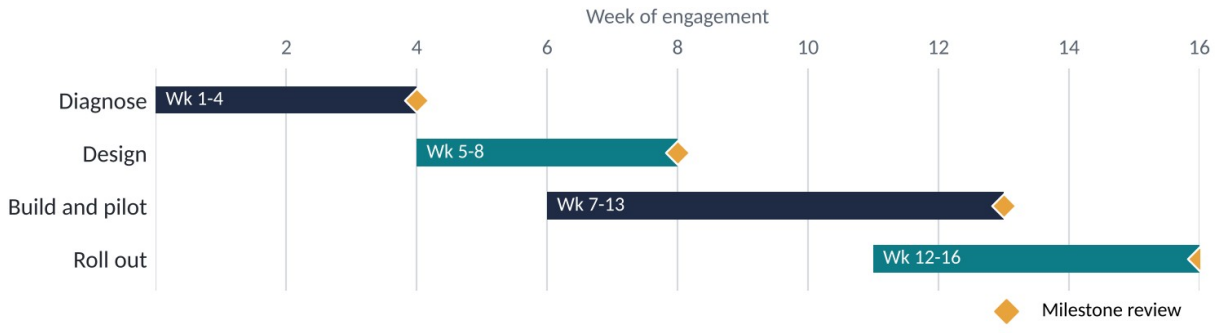


Figure 1. Indicative 16-week plan from kick-off. Diamonds mark milestone reviews.

3.2 Phase detail

Phase 1: Diagnose (weeks 1-4)

Map the current quote-to-cash flow, measure cycle time per step and quantify the cost of rework.

- Stakeholder interviews (operations, finance, sales)
- Process mapping and data sampling
- Root-cause analysis and baseline metrics

Milestone: Diagnosis readout

Phase 2: Design (weeks 5-8)

Define the target process, data model and controls, and agree the integration specification.

- Target-state process and role design
- Integration and data specification
- Control and audit requirements

Milestone: Design sign-off

Phase 3: Build and pilot (weeks 7-13)

Build the integration, test with real shipments and run a live pilot at one depot.

- Integration build and test
- Pilot depot go-live
- Daily defect triage and tuning

Milestone: Pilot go-live

Phase 4: Roll out (weeks 12-16)

Extend to two further depots, train teams and hand over to client owners. Best option adds 90 days of hypercare.

- Depot rollout waves
- Training and playbooks
- Handover and benefits review

Milestone: Handover

4. Deliverables

Each deliverable is accepted by the client's nominated owner at the milestone review for its phase. The Option column shows the lowest option that includes it.

Ref	Deliverable	Description	Phase	Option
D1	Current-state process map and baseline metrics	Annotated end-to-end map; cycle time and rework baseline	Diagnose	Good
D2	Target-state design pack	Process, roles, controls, data model	Design	Good
D3	Integration specification	Field mapping, error handling, reconciliation rules	Design	Good
D4	Working TMS-to-accounting integration	Tested build deployed to pilot depot	Build and pilot	Better
D5	Pilot results report	Cycle time vs baseline, defects, lessons	Build and pilot	Better
D6	Depot rollout and training	Two further depots live; trained staff; playbooks	Roll out	Best
D7	90-day hypercare	Named support, weekly metrics review, fixes	Roll out	Best

5. Assumptions and dependencies

The scope and prices in this document rely on the following. If any proves incorrect we will raise a change request before proceeding.

1. [Client] provides access to TMS and accounting administrators within five working days of kick-off.
2. Both systems expose supported APIs or file imports; if not, a change request will be raised.
3. The client nominates one accountable business owner with authority to approve deliverables within five working days.
4. Pilot depot staff are available for up to four hours per week during design and pilot.
5. Third-party licence or vendor fees for either system are excluded.
6. Work is performed remotely with up to three on-site visits per depot; travel is billed at cost.

6. Pricing and options

We offer three options. All are fixed-fee for the stated scope. Better is our recommendation: it proves the benefit on live shipments before any wider commitment.

Scope	Good	Better (recommended)	Best
Summary	Diagnose and design	Plus build and pilot	Plus rollout and hypercare
Process diagnosis and baseline (D1)	✓	✓	✓
Target-state design pack (D2)	✓	✓	✓
Integration specification (D3)	✓	✓	✓
Integration build and test (D4)	–	✓	✓
Live pilot at one depot and results report (D5)	–	✓	✓
Rollout to two further depots and training (D6)	–	–	✓
90-day hypercare (D7)	–	–	✓
Duration	**8 weeks**	**13 weeks**	**16 weeks + 90 days**
Fixed fee	**GBP 38,000**	**GBP 84,000**	**GBP 126,000**

6.1 Payment schedule

30% on signature, 40% on design sign-off, 30% on final milestone acceptance. Fees are fixed for the scope above and exclude taxes and expenses.

Prices are in GBP and valid until 31 January 2027.

7. Terms and conditions

The clauses below are placeholders to be completed by each party's legal counsel before signature. Square brackets mark text that must be replaced.

Clause	Text
Payment terms	[Payment terms, e.g. net 30 days from invoice - to be confirmed by [Your Consultancy] legal]
Change control	[Change request process and rate card - to be inserted]
Intellectual property	[Ownership of deliverables and pre-existing materials - to be inserted]
Confidentiality	[Confidentiality clause or reference to existing NDA - to be inserted]
Limitation of liability	[Liability cap and exclusions - to be inserted]
Governing law	[Jurisdiction and governing law - to be inserted]

8. Acceptance

By signing below, [Client Company] accepts this proposal and statement of work, including the option selected, and authorises [Your Consultancy] to proceed.

Option selected: [ ] Good [ ] Better [ ] Best

[Your Consultancy]	[Client Company]
SIGNATURE	**SIGNATURE**
NAME [Your Name]	**NAME**
TITLE Engagement Partner	**TITLE**
DATE	**DATE**